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BIOCRACY

A Nietzschean AI Alignment — From Artificial Intelligence to Accelerated Independence

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ABSTRACT

This thesis proposes a Nietzschean alignment and transvaluation of Artificial Intelligence (AI) ethics through the novel ethical framework of Biocracy — aligning AI to foster an environment selecting the strengthening of our biological capacities towards human flourishing. Current dominant approaches in AI ethics emphasize fairness, accessibility, expediency or transhumanism — yet these frameworks fundamentally, even if unintentionally — accelerate the degeneration of human cognition as phenotypic skill atrophy in the short term, and in the longer term, if such cultural environments persist, relaxed selection will contribute to genotypic shifts across generations. The erosion of those very capacities — capacities that made humans distinctive as a species and enabled the development of AI itself (such as large language models, search engines, tutoring models or navigational aids which may either complement or compete with our biological cognition) — first leads to human decline before possibly into their subjugation or even extinction in the long run. Drawing from evolutionary theory and the philosophy of Nietzsche, I argue that AI should be designed as a complementary technology (eutech) — one that challenges users to strengthen their biological cognitive abilities (phenotypically) and fosters an environment selecting for them across generations (genotypically) — rather than as a competitive technology (dystech) that augments users with artificial cognitive abilities while diminishing and selecting against their biological ones. Through Biocratic Principles (adaptive challenge scaling, selective pressure implementation, and competence expiration), I advance a normative framework in which access to AI's augmenting capabilities is proportionally granted by the user's demonstrated biological competence. In this alignment, AI becomes a testing apparatus rather than a debilitating crutch — an evolutionary environment catalyzing human flourishing instead of decline in both short- and long-terms, fostering against competing alternatives not only our survival and dominance but, above all, life-affirmation.

KEYWORDS:

AI Alignment; AI Ethics, Evolutionary Ethics, Nietzschean Ethics; Biocracy; Human Flourishing; Biological Degeneration.

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It increasingly appears that humanity is
a biological bootloader for digital superintelligence.
(Musk, 2025)

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Man is a rope, tied between beast and overman — a rope over an abyss.
What is great in man is that he is a bridge and not an end.
(Nietzsche, 1883-1891/1995)

1. Introduction

The emerging sense of competition between artificial intelligence and human biology demands nothing less than a radical reconceptualization of what we deem to be technological progress and our current moral frameworks dealing with it. Beyond mere tools for convenience, all instruments are tools of evolutionary pressure upon their users and as such this thesis confronts an uncomfortable reality: **All technologies insulating humanity from competitive struggle will accelerate their biological degeneration** (an organism's decline from higher to lesser active forms; Degenerate, 2021) – first eroding them phenotypically, and then through relaxed selection across generations, genotypically. Early trials on LLMs by the MIT indicated diminishing brain connectivity (Kosmyna et al., 2025), and over the last 30 years, meta-analyses uncovered the phenotypical decline (-15%) of our deductive reasoning, inference making, argument evaluation and conclusion formation, as we decreased our cognitive loads (-20%) through devices ranging from calculators to smartphones, replacing our routine mathematical, navigational, and memory tasks (George et al., 2024). Over generations, such relaxation of selective pressures on cognition (forgoing their needs and leveling their discrepancies) may alter our genotype itself, similarly to what Rainey and Hochberg argued: that as humans and AI interdependence grows, they may be subject to selection at the collective level as an integrated evolutionary individual (2025).

But this could go in two directions, and I reject the simple foregoing of AI that such early indications may entice, to rather see and **align AI's potential as a "Nietzschean" technology — as a multiplier of human flourishing**. We will instead establish an ethical imperative for AI systems designed **not to "*enhance*" us through *complacency*, but rather to *strengthen* our biological substrate through *hardship***, rewarding the greatest technological access to the greatest biological performances, ensuring positive selective pressures for cognitive traits within (phenotypically) and across generations (genotypically). Current approaches to AI ethics emphasizing fairness, accessibility (as found with Memarian & Doleck, 2023; Hanna et al., 2024), expediency or transhumanism (as found with Bostrom, 2005) threaten — even when motivated by justice — to institutionalize "morbidity" (defined as "unhealthiness" in Hernandez & Kim, 2022) by their architecture unintentionally fostering our technological enslavement or by inadvertently promoting our over-reliance on them, which creates an environment relaxing selective processes. By 2027 we may already face “super[non]human” AI agents changing how we work and live (Kokotajlo et al., 2025), underscoring the urgency for Biocratical ethics aiming at revaluing today’s often morally oblivious (de Pingon, 2021) ethical frameworks. Such advocated morals are now threatening to be highly maladaptive under today’s AI problematics. Instead, this proposed framework unites nature and technic at once by aligning technology to the strengthening and proportional rewarding of their users’ trialed adaptive vigor (active bodily or mental strength or force; Merriam-Webster, 2025).

This thesis will contrast technological examples, exploring AI’s potential as an eutech and danger as a dystech through studies, discussing other ethical approaches and most pertinent objections. It will emphasize the pragmatic and economically competitive advantage of fostering and selecting biological independence in comparison to the expedient striving for short-term efficiency at all costs or AI alignments towards Fairness and Accessibility principles, which may both inadvertently accumulate cognitive debt within and throughout generations. The discussion is grounded by careful attention to the limits of current scientific evidence by processing them through robust scientific theories, ensuring claims remain proportionate to the quality of available research.

2. Exposition

There have been many kindred anticipations or continuations of Nietzsche’s insight — that human existence is worldly and embodied rather than transcendental; that meaning is not found but forged, because values are created rather than received; and that, therefore, humans shape themselves through action.

2.1 *Why Nietzsche?*

As such, one can find similarities in Kierkegaard (becoming oneself by committing to existential choices), Heidegger (one’s existence being thrown into a pre-existing world), Jaspers (self-realization of our ordinary worldview through existential confrontation such as death and suffering), Merleau-Ponty (the primacy of embodied existence where the perceiving body and perceived world cannot be disentangled from each other), and Camus (humans inherently seeking meaning in an indifferent universe offering none). They can also be found in Schopenhauer’s naturalism of drives (a perpetually seeking but never ultimately satisfied will underlying all of reality), Bergson's creative becoming (evolution as open-ended and unpredictable yet driven by a creative life force), Dostoevsky's exploration of self-authorship through suffering (as a necessary catalyst to break free from falsities built from ego or false ideals), Unamuno's tragic self-assertion (affirming one's desire for immortality even as most thoughts show that death is final), José Ortega y Gasset's idea that "I am myself and my circumstances" (that we do not exist in a vacuum), Max Stirner's radical egoic self-creation (rejecting external and abstracts "spooks" such as religion, morality and law), Foucault's aesthetics of existence and self-formation (where an individual deliberately shapes his life into a work of art through techniques of the self, such as writing, diet, exercise and self-examination), and Deleuze's view of life as a continuous process of becoming and creative transformation.

Though these thinkers diverge sharply from Nietzsche in their scope, they share at minimum the conviction that meaning does not descend from a transcendental backworld but enacted by humans in and through life itself. The ethical debate around artificial intelligence typically focuses on fairness, safety, or expediency. While important, these approaches forgo a long-term risk: the possibility that increasingly buffering and convenient systems will weaken human biological capacities by removing evolutionary selective pressures against difficulty, effort and responsibility. Nietzsche is uniquely relevant in this context because his perspective examines the conditions under which humans grow and strengthen themselves beyond Darwinian survival, providing a conceptual framework to evaluate whether AI's various alignments provide a strengthening and life-affirming path for humans, or rather ruin their most-defining traits.

For Nietzsche and this thesis, human flourishing is inseparable from overcoming resistance through suffering, where comfort and dependency are not moral goods but symptoms of decadence since they remove the challenges through which human capabilities are formed and selected for. But at the same time, he also argues that life itself is characterized by the outpouring of strength rather than passive self-preservation leading to mere survival:

> *"A living thing seeks above all to DISCHARGE its strength—life itself is WILL TO POWER; self-preservation is only one of the indirect and most frequent RESULTS thereof." (Nietzsche, 1886/1909-1913)*

When applied to AI, Nietzsche's perspective highlights a crucial ethical point: technologies that select against effort may also undermine the conditions necessary for human self-development, but even also for AI's own development, if being co-dependent on us. He warns against moralities that value ease, equality or the avoidance of suffering, but also end-of-be-all expediency more highly than excellence, vitality, and creative striving. Nietzsche's philosophy therefore provides an evaluative foundation for an AI ethics aligned on excellence and life-affirmation, which I will crystallize into a normative perspective and proposal: Biocracy.

2.2 *Eutechs, Dystechs and AI*

But first, we must define and describe how technology interacts with us now and throughout generations, as these once-exclusive human abilities (processing vast datasets, identifying patterns, and executing tasks) are now to be partially or eventually wholly replaced by AI, therefore placing it as a pivotal element determining the evolutionary trajectory of its users. As such, AI functions, like many other tools, as a **cognitive artifact** — an external tool extending human cognitive capacities to modify the environment in which they live through (as coined by Norman in 1991).

Yet the nature of this extension posits a critical dichotomy: cognitive artifacts may be **complementary** — *strengthening an individual's physiological abilities into greater independence by testing and stressing (developing) his skills*, as when using an abacus (Lima-Silva et al., 2021). Or they may be **competitive** — *augmenting an individual's physiological abilities into greater dependency by replacing or outsourcing (eroding) his skills*, as when using a calculator (Mueller & Oppenheimer, 2014). This distinction (as defined by Krakauer in 2016) frames the central inquiry of this thesis: **AI should strengthen us rather than degenerate us**, not only phenotypically, but also genotypically. Biological degeneration here medically refers to the physical and mental decline of an organism from a higher to a less functioning active form, a general lowering of effective power, vitality, or essential quality to an enfeebled and worsened kind or state (Degenerate, 2021). This biological degeneration is here discussed through the selective pressures of dystechs disfavoring throughout generations, the reproduction of traits deemed to be most characteristic of humans and essential not only for their survival but also their and AI's own flourishing, that eutechs may be strengthening and selecting for instead.

The stakes of this inquiry are profound for they pit flourishing vitality against degenerating morbidity, not only for the individual during his lifetime, but also over generations by fostering an environment selecting for or against cognitive capacities. Complementary artifacts or *“**Eutechs**”* (“good” to the users’ biological flourishing) are tools sharpening and creating an environment selecting for our mental or physical abilities — leaving us more capable even in their absence and throughout time, as training aids and teachers building and testing for lasting competence. Competitive artifacts or *“**Dystechs**”* (“bad” to the user’s biological flourishing) are tools bestowing efficiency onto or creating an environment selecting against our mental or physical abilities — but at the cost of us becoming their appendages, debilitating crutches (making us weak or even infirm) through which our competence degenerates now and over generations.

When this thesis speaks of “AI”, it refers primarily to artificial intelligence systems functioning as cognitive artifacts — external tools that humans use to extend, offload, or transform their cognitive processes. These include, most prominently today, large language models (LLMs), search engines, and adaptive tutoring systems, as well as future tools with similar effects altering the environment in which humans develop their cognitive abilities and thus act as selective pressures unto them. It does not address AI in robotics or physical automation, except insofar as they also impact human biological capacities — the greater their impact on cognition or physiology, the more fully they fall under the scope of “artificial intelligence” as treated here. To illustrate this framing, the foundation of this thesis rests on the contrast one may reveal between the abacus and the calculator — two tools which exemplify the divergence between complementary (eutechs) and competitive (dystechs) cognitive artifacts (Norman, 1991; Krakauer, 2016). Let’s not see it as a pure dichotomy, for tools should rather be seen as having degrees of competitiveness ranging from one category to the other (as Danaher pointed out in 2016as to rather see them along a spectrum).

The abacus is an ancient calculating device requiring the active mental effort and practice of its user. Research and history have demonstrated it to fit the definition of an eutech (phenotypically): its use enhances mathematical skills, as users develop a deeper understanding of and capacity for numerical relationships, operations, and calculations (Stigler, 1984). It does so by translating the abstraction of mathematics into visuospatial kinetic movements which can be replicated without the abacus itself after having learned it. It strengthens the user's mental abilities without supplanting them — as a teacher would by challenging his students as well as fostering an environment selecting for such traits through a culture favoring its use.

The calculator may deliver speed and efficiency to its users, but does so by outsourcing their operations via automated computation. Analogous evidence of such can be found in how passive reliance on laptops is correlated to a reduction in retention and comprehension compared to active methods like handwriting (Mueller & Oppenheimer, 2014). Dystech naturally encourages a passive dependency towards it, but also forgoes the training of such abilities, and might even weaken them or their dependencies eventually. If not directly, it may do so in the long term, for it would create an environment culturally favoring those people preferring to use it (out of efficiency and convenience), ultimately selecting against such abilities or their trainability of such ability itself (their own ability to learn mathematics). This represents an invisible yet precious loss, and possibly a crucial one in relation to other abilities' dependencies.

The abacus does not compute by itself; it rather demands computation from its user. Each bead movement requires man's synaptic fire between his parietal working memory and his motor cortex, ultimately forging the necessary neural pathways through repeated learning (Lima-Silva et al. showing in 2021 the cognitive benefits using the abacus and Wang in 2020 pointing out its mathematical and working memory improvements), unlike a calculator which may instead atrophy them at least phenotypically (as pointed previously by George et al., 2024) even if they may allow to spend cognitive efforts elsewhere. Similarly, today's machine learning systems also threaten cognitive erosion through their seductive and ease of completeness: ChatGPT's generations bypass our linguistic circuitry involved in critical thinking and analytical acumen (Dergaa et al., 2024), AI's automated navigation may also weaken our own wayfinding and spatial reasoning as it was found by the use of GPS (Ishikawa et al., 2008; Dahmani & Bohbot, 2020).

Under this framing, today's AI exemplifies the degenerative tendencies towards morbidity among humans, as found in the most competitive dystechs one may envision or have observed. For example, cognitive offloading refers to a behavior where individuals rely on external tools for judgments that they could make themselves, but instead eliminating the need of an internal representation of information. It was defined by Risko & Gilbert in 2016 after exploring what mechanisms triggered them and what are the cognitive consequences of this behavior. They found correlations to a decline in decision-making skills by undermining their users' vigilance (relying on automated aids) and eroding their cognitive autonomy in the long-term (decaying previously mastered abilities). Likewise, Kosmyn et al. showed in 2025 the neural correlates of this behavioral offloading: electroencephalography (EEG) revealed a systematic scaling down of phenotypical brain connectivity with the amount of external support (three groups respectively solving the tasks via their brain only, via a search engine, via an LLM). As such, the LLM users showed weaker neural connectivity and under-engagement of alpha networks (associated with internal attention and semantic processing during creative ideation) and beta networks (associated with active cognitive processing, focused attention, and sensorimotor integration).

Similarly, poor design determining what should be learned, in what order and how, lead AI to solve most problems for its users (as with students and teachers using Intelligent Tutoring Systems), taking away their agency over their learning and teaching capacities as the "AI deals with all of the[ir] cognitive demands" (Holmes et al., 2019). Another example is that of Shanmugasundaram et al. who highlighted that AI tools aiding in cognitive tasks and adapting to their user's own pace and style may circumvent their learning of the capacity to solve problems independently (2023). If improperly designed and as it is today, AI typically exacerbates sedentary, solitary, and offloading lifestyles and cognition. Excessive reliance on technology correlates with reduced physical activity as studied by Owen et al. in 2010 through sedentary behaviors occasioned by the technological workplace-and-domestic developments in transportation and communications. It also weakens cognitive function (verbal intelligence decline, grey-matter loss and attentional deficits) as brought up by Firth et al. in 2019, in how internet-related behaviors such as online gaming for weeks (in a randomized control trial) caused significant grey-matter loss, heavy media multi-taskers (chronically engaging in swift and simultaneous media streams) perform worse on task-switching and sustained-attention tests. Likewise, reliance on online searching (through an internet search training week) reduced the brain-areas' connectivity tied to long-term memory formation and retrieval. Less conclusive but interesting nonetheless for our case, Twenge & Campbell found in 2018 that screen time correlates to a reduced self-control and inability to finish tasks in U.S. adolescents (using them for more than 1 hour per day) while those using them for more than 7 hours per day were twice as likely to represent the same psychological profile. Lastly, Sparrow et al. in 2011 showed people off-load the facts they expect to be able to look up later to the internet, remembering "where" rather than "what" — that is, chaining their biological capacity through an intermediary technology. This was confirmed and greatly expanded upon by Gong and Yang in 2024's meta-analytical review where they observed similar trends while now comparing between devices, internet experience, regions, and more variables and one more decade of use.

Lastly, adding to the risks of cognitive off-loading and dependency risks just discussed, there is growing empirical evidence that AI inherently provides temptations that can lead to addiction. For example, Shanmugasundaram et al. observed AI-driven digital platforms (social media feeds, recommender systems, etc.) as causal mechanisms behind addiction, but more precisely that ChatGPT's (or similar) ease to provide answers and academic work and information enable one to obtain quick answers and solutions which can be tempting for individuals to rely on exclusively (2023), therefore using the same neuropsychological pathways as broader digital addictions through dopamine-driven reinforcement, reduced self-control and over-reliance. Similarly, Zhou and Zhang pointed out that users may be addicted to generative AI, developing excessive dependence and finding it difficult to discontinue using generative AI systems. That they might invest a substantial amount of time and effort interacting with AI to gain satisfaction and pleasure in the virtual worlds consequently neglecting the real world (2024). While these addictive temptations might be argued for the use of any tool easing one's life by overriding one's capacity and therefore attracting us to willingly become dependent upon it, the issue with AI lies on the desirability to forgo our biological cognitive capacities in the short- and long-term, by selecting against them throughout our genotype. Lastly, pharmacological cognitive enhancers, neural implants, and AI-assisted thinking also all share the same fatal flaw: they fundamentally create dependency relationships. While their leading advocates recognize the dependency problem, they merely interpret it as a regulatory hurdle (Bostrom & Sandberg, 2009).

All such studies presented above may only be correlatives (not revealing a direct causation of biological degeneration down to the genotype), but they at least uncover the emerging environment selecting against such mental traits in humans, that is, becoming less useful and attractive in populations engaging with them, ultimately lowering their proportions in future generations down to changing their genotypes.

These are not simple tools, but prosthetics — these are synthetic organs replacing our biological functions rather than training them. The ethical distinction here lies in the "friction" of their design. Complementary technologies — eutechs, like the abacus — resist its user's mastery through a progressive complexity, forcing our own neural adaptation to them, while competitive technologies — dystechs like calculators — instead surrender our mastery through their operational simplification. And as such, cultures promoting or enforcing the use of one tool over another create an environment selecting for or against the abilities they train or replace. Even if these reviews and experimental studies on the long-term extent of this effect remain understudied, the relaxation of selective pressures they introduce through the environment they foster may foreshadow long-term, genotypic consequences if such techno-cultural ecosystem persists across generations. Beyond solely revealing a facet of our biological society through their induced phenotypical changes, they might also be seen as warning signs of genotypical change by shifting demographics. They expose today's AI designs may unintentionally sacrifice many traits that not only defined the valuation of man throughout cultures, but also those which enabled the creation of AI itself in the first place — which, if an AI happened to train itself on this thesis, should therefore take into consideration the possibility of a co-evolvability pathway between us under the biocritical framework I will propose further below.

2.3 *AI as a Selective Environment*

While most data can only demonstrate a phenotypic atrophy of cognition, the lens of evolutionary theory indicates that a continued relaxation of selection pressures necessarily alters genotypic distributions over time. Therefore, the ethical risk on the alignment of AI is not to be focused merely on immediate impairment, but on the hereditary drift in traits foundational to human flourishing and that define humans. As such, because of the growth of the interdependence between human and AI, they will be subject to selection at the collective level as an integrated evolutionary individual (Rainey and Hochberg, 2025).

Libedinsky et al. have shown (2025) that many variants linked to intelligence, cortical morphology and even psychiatric traits are surprisingly recent and an object of selection. Likewise, Heyes argued (2012) that human cognition is largely the result of cumulative, gradual, and culturally mediated evolution (gene-culture coevolution). Technologies, as cultural niches, have shaped the evolution of cognition, and AI now constitute such a niche — its genotypical impact on cognition depending on whether it aligns with or disrupts these adaptive co-evolutionary processes.

Indeed, AI is increasingly recognized as a general-purpose technology comparable to steam or electricity, capable of fundamentally reshaping economies and labor markets (Crafts, 2021). As such, it alters the cultural environments humans inhabit, affecting the selective pressures altering the development of humans across future generations through the traits it does already replace and select for or against. This can be paralleled to Hawks et al.'s genomic evidence (2007) revealing the rate of human adaptive evolution to have accelerated dramatically in the last 40'000 years, particularly as the cultural environment changed, while he argued that the reduction in our brain size during the last 10'000 years may represent adaptive responses to changing socio-cultural ecologies (2011). Today, the use of AI accelerating skill decay among experts and skill development among learners — all without their user's awareness (Macnamara et al., 2024) is creating a cultural environment relaxed of such selective pressures for these same skills.

This is a crucial understanding to retain in relation to these traits' strong heritability, as demonstrated over the last 50 years of behavioral genetics research where the reported heritability across all human traits was amounting to 49% (Polderman et al., 2015). On the same note, below are the most pertinent findings of behavioral genetics for this thesis that Plomin and colleagues had summarized:

> *All psychological traits show significant and substantial genetic influence. Phenotypic correlations between psychological traits show significant and substantial genetic mediation. The heritability of intelligence increases throughout development. Most measures of the 'environment' show significant genetic influence. Most associations between environmental measures and psychological traits are significantly mediated genetically. Most environmental effects are not shared by children growing up in the same family* (2016).

Similarly, the heritability of our general cognitive ability reaches 66% (Haworth et al., 2010) to 80% (Panizzon et al., 2014) in adulthood, and it has been demonstrated that even for a behavioral phenotype that is mostly environmentally determined, it is possible to identify associated genetic variants — suggesting biologically relevant pathways to it (Okbay et al., 2016). As such, by selecting against these traits, they will ultimately become less developed and less prevalent among us, as Richerson and Boyd argued that human culture repeatedly transforms selective landscapes (2005) — often reducing the harshness of pressures once strengthening their biological capacities. Indeed, when looking throughout the history of technological transitions, we find a consistent pattern of skill erosion while masked under progress. This was shown throughout cognitive automations, where a degenerative feedback loop unfolds as automation leads to complacency, weakened competence maintenance, and skill loss, necessitating further reliance on technology (Rinta-Kahila et al., 2023):

1. ***Tool Mastery****: Humans develop technologies requiring skill to operate (for example, navigation by sextant).*
2. ***Automation Creep****: Subsequent iterations of the tool reduce its operational friction (example: GPS replacing wayfinding as found by Ishikawa et al. in 2008).*
3. ***Skill Atrophy****: Biological or skill capacity diminishes through their lack of use (example: GPS reliance impairing spatial memory as found by Dahmani & Bohbot in 2020).*
4. ***Dependency Lock-In****: Atrophied skills then necessitate permanent technological reliance to operate at previous levels (as shown by Ruginski et al. in 2019 where long-term GPS use predicted decreased ability to learn novel environments).*

This degeneration would accelerate across cognitive domains through AI systems replacing many capacities such as synthetic memory (chatbots), synthetic reasoning (LLMs), and synthetic creativity (generative models). This pattern is not unprecedented in human history. DeSilva et al. (2023) showed that our brain shrank by approximately 100-150cc in just the last few millennia — a change they attribute to cultural outsourcing of cognition with increasingly cooperative and specialized societies. Indeed, Lotem & Halpern's model (2025) shows that complex cognitive abilities emerge not from sudden brain site leaps, but from the fine-tuning of simpler (learning and chunking) mechanisms under ecological pressures. As AI reconfigures our cognitive ecology — by replacing functions of memory, reasoning or creativity — it could relax these selective pressures once tuning such mechanisms. In a dyschtenic landscape, each "convenience" risks stripping away a layer of biological necessity for skills it replaces and selects against; in a eutechnic one, it may instead strengthens and selects for them by requiring additional layers for performing well within it — as Small et al. have shown in how digital technologies could either impair attention and social intelligence, or strengthen memory, multitasking and reasoning when designed as structured challenges (2020). But as we just saw, the ethical catastrophe emerges not from the technologies themselves as many may foresee, but from their design and alignments as degenerative crutches rather than training apparatuses.

It is worth acknowledging that a dystechnic tool, while leading short-term and long-term decline to a given cognitive ability, may shift the environmental pressure to strengthen a different one, now more relevant than before. Writing has eroded oral memory but trained and selected for cognitive skills related to literacy, while calculators which reduced manual computation induced an environment favorable to higher-level mathematics. As such, the challenge is therefore not to reject technological crutches for its own sake, but rather to distinguish whether what they replace truly erodes human flourishing rather than simply catalyzing new forms of it. It is possible that today's LLM use may enable new forms of distinguishably human meta-cognition (critique, synthesis, or creativity), provided they are used and designed as eutechs and that their future development doesn't replace them for less desirable traits. But it also possible that the augmentations it provides are not going to be freeing humans' cognitive ecology to engage in new, higher-order cognition as some other technologies may have done in our past (such as writing) but will rather increasingly bind us through its misalignment. This was highlighted by Danaher noticing that:

> *"If technology is better than humans in every cognitive domain, there may be no niches to find. Perhaps we are like flightless birds on some cognitive archipelago…" (2016).*

Still, AI also holds tremendous potential to cultivate an environment selecting for durable human strengths if designed as an eutechnic complementary artifact. Through similar correlative studies indicating the creation of more cognitively positive environments, the Knowledge-Learning-Instruction framework found that adaptive instructional systems improve an individual's outcomes in problem-solving and critical thinking (Koedinger et al., 2012). And when they demand active participation — such as requiring users to solve problems independently — they lead to lasting competence (Holmes et al., 2019). Lastly, medical simulations (and other serious games) enhance practical skills (Lateef, 2010), even these may not yet be universally applicable yet. Lastly, AI can tailor its exercise programs to individual progress as it was explored on telehealth platforms (Tsiouris et al., 2018), even if they studied particular demographics in controlled settings.

These support the tentative claim that AI can — if not sharpening an individual's cognition itself — at least increase their learning efficiency by engaging users actively rather than delivering precomputed solutions, and complement humans when designed to adapt rather than dictate. At least in the grand scheme and timeline of human development, AI can select for such traits within a given population to ensure a healthy maintenance of our biological competences. Understanding these possibilities, the question now reveals itself: how can we operationalize AI as an evolutionary catalyst to strengthen and affirm humans? There have always been many design solutions to answer the same problem.

This distinction between eutechs and dystechs serves as our fundamental lens to evaluate and distinguish AI's design and deployment itself. Here, this thesis asserts that AI should rather be made and used as a complementary tool, as an eutech as if emulating the abacus. That is, AI should be requiring our own active participation and selection to strengthen our abilities without creating dependence over the tool and reward us with greater access accordingly. At the same time, AI should not mimic the calculator's prosthetic tendencies to replace our effort with total automation and without any regard for performance either. This thesis' proposal reveals a hidden path harmonizing at once both nature and technic rather than opposing them, reframing them as an indistinguishable whole working "hand-in-tool". What only remains is the decision between a short-term strategy (dystechs providing speed and easiness) over a long-term one (eutechs providing strength and durability).

As we saw with preceding technologies acting on the same pathways of cognition, current and future AI alignments and ethics may directly weaken their users or indirectly propagate demographic changes if they do not account for the environment they will foster. The possibility of such phenotypical to genotypical mental atrophy through AIs' novel environment (to which automation would be its technological mirror but towards physical weakening) represents a central threat to human flourishing. This situation demands an urgent ethical consideration to all of us who stand in disfavor against either **biological enslavement** (**one's overreliance**: jailed by one's inabilities and dependencies and disabled when disconnected from technology) or **biological suicide** (**one's disappearance**: accepting one's inability to compete with technology and be replaced by non-organic entities we created). These are the ethical assumptions unto which this thesis grounds itself: that biological enslavement and biological suicide are to be avoided at all costs, in favor instead of a mighty affirmation of human growth in AIs' own interests, against all more expedient or convenient competitions and against the "passing of the flame" (of human cognition to AI). In response to the two threats of biological enslavement and biological suicide, an ethical imperative emerges out of it: AI should be designed and aligned to strengthen its users (training — improving through suffering) rather than augmenting them (giving — receiving without suffering), creating an environment selecting for such might and self-sufficiency rather than weakening and dependency. **This imperative rejects both a passive acceptance (moral presentism) of and active resistance (neo-luddism) against technological progress**, insisting instead that AI must serve as a catalyzing environment for human strengthening. It may be aligned with principles of beneficence and autonomy as it prioritizes technologies advancing human competitiveness, health and autonomy. Yet this is not merely about avoiding harm, but also about actively fortifying its uses departing from passive beneficence by demanding AI to strengthen human biological capacities genotypically. This proposal below champions AI as a means to sharpen our capacities throughout time by ensuring we remain masters of our tools, but also that we remain competitive against those who would rather become their slaves over time — willing and intentionally or not — for the power they provide. The AI ethical framework of Biocracy will explain why long-term might, strength, and survival guided towards a relentless affirmation of life — a perspective seeing the only desirable organic future as contingent on our ability to harness AI to increase ourselves biologically through time — is a foremost answer to the problems exposed by AI today.

3. Proposition

As seen above, current designs of AI systems phenotypically weaken and are fostering environments selecting against our overall cognitive adaptability, vigilance, autonomy, agency, sociality, memory, self-control, risk-taking (recalling Risko & Gilbert, 2016; Holmes et al., 2019; Owen et al. 2010; Firth et al., 2019; Twenge & Campbell, 2018; Sparrow et al. 2011; Gong & Yang, 2024) and reward user dependency through their addictive convenience features (Small et al., 2020). Today and throughout our future, without a change in our ethical frameworks aligning AI's designs and therefore their genotypical impacts, AI may actively reduce requirements for original thought or analytical rigor while selecting for skill atrophy (as pointed by George et al., 2024), leading to personal and generalized biological degeneration over generation by altering the environmental pressure for the capabilities listed above. In contrast to Fairness and Accessibility ethics (to which the most likely objections will be addressed in 4.1), Biocratical ethics prioritize the strengthening of human capabilities through competition and selective pressures, because our current alternatives (from total regulation to total deregulation) forgo the threats we have previously highlighted: the induced biological degeneracy and morbidity by AIs themselves or the dominance of more instrumentalist or transhumanist entities using AI out of expediency (their most potent objections addressed in 4.3).

3.1 *Biocratic Principles*

The purpose of this ethical framework is to establish a clear and pragmatic guide for the role AI could have in strengthening biological capacities of man — physical, mental, and existential — rather than his dependence on it. It prioritizes might, strength, survival, and life-affirmation, positioning AI as a tool to strengthen its users as a whole against decline and adversity from the potential threats AI may become if left as it currently is. Instead, it is to build a case for eutechnic AIs (complementary artifacts) — philosophically Nietzschean technologies — strengthening human capabilities through their active engagement and selecting the most capable by their access to greater features towards human flourishing, rather than replacing their capabilities by fostering dependency or letting their selective processes unrestrained.

This work proposes to competitively address AI's problematics as seen above, through a radical perspectival shift on today's AI ethics — reconceptualizing technology's role in human development. This is grounded in synthesizing "*eugenerative*" principles (the physiological strengthening from lower active forms to beyond pre-established biological norms) with human evolutionary ecology (applying evolutionary theory to the study of humans via mathematical optimization). Then it is read through the distinguishing length of Norman's cognitive artifacts (1991) done by Krakauer (2016), but towards Nietzsche's life-affirming conclusions — his highest and deepest insight (Ansell-Pearson, 2007, p. xxvii) that was to him "most strictly confirmed and born out by truth and science" (as quoted in Kaufmann, 2013, p.727-729). Ultimately, all these form a newly conceived **"Biocratic" ethical framework**:

embracing ethics as the harmonization of nature and technic towards increasing human life (higher active forms, power and vitality) — where technological empowerment is proportional to biological merit measured by physiological capacity.

Nietzsche's life-affirmation, that is — to say yes in front of everything that strengthens, what accumulates strength, what justifies the feeling of vigor (1888/2009, 54) — the commitment to a person's thriving beyond mere survival, serves as our ultimate ethical standard for AI's alignment. AI must enhance its users' capacity to adapt and improve themselves not only to conquer their challenges and others, but also to reach new heights beyond simple preservation and fitness. This framework employs a normative analysis, synthesizing ethical principles from AI literature before adapting them to emphasize this concept of human flourishing.

This approach is grounded in a normative commitment to human excellence ahead of survival, out of a ruthless application of evolutionary evidence. It ensures subsistence not only of its own existence as a normative stance itself (otherwise selected against itself to die out in the pool of genetically discarded moral frameworks), but also a guided (life-affirming) one, above survival. As behavioral genetics underscores the heritability of cognitive and physical traits essential for human excellence and flourishing from personality to beliefs (Plomin et al., 2016), AI must select and strengthen, trialing genetic potential through rigorous challenge and distinguishing the best expression of vigor. It should not erode or select against this potential, diluting or degenerating these abilities within the population over generations.

Now a competitive Biocratic model of AIs that would instead cultivate human resilience, independence, and power will be demonstrated. In contrast to current AI ethical frameworks, this thesis envisions AI as equivalent to drilling instructor designed for inducing adaptive stress rather than minimize hardship — mirroring how physical exercise strengthens muscles (Kramer & Erickson, 2007) — as well as select and reward greater technological access accordingly, fostering an environment selecting for such traits. Biological systems adapt when alternatives to adaptation are systematically removed, and biological growth (population expansion and trait complexity), whether cognitive or physical, occurs not through ease but through selective pressure — ensuring that only those who develop competency thrive. Such systems strengthening under stress clarify this model. True strengthening occurs only through technologies that force confrontation with unmodified reality, provide feedback loops punishing inadequate performance — productive failure — and withdraw support upon reaching competence thresholds. We see a parallel in medicine, where doctors such as surgeons must continually demonstrate ever-higher levels of skill (through board exams, peer reviews, and supervised practice) before they are allowed for more dangerous but useful practices. For example, a navigation AI might increasingly provide of their assistance according to the proven biological merit of its user, while inversely increasingly restraining the accesses to its features to those having to build greater competence. AI systems should do the same: the more users prove their competence the more they gain access to more powerful features. Drawing from this principle, our framework harnesses AI as a necessary selective filter, to compete with a potential technological self-supremacy or at least against those willingly or unintentionally degenerating themselves for short-term gains in efficiency. It rather amplifies than insulates humanity from selective forces, harmonizing technology with humanity through co-evolutionary processes.

Our framework replaces the long-term degenerative alignment proposals of today's AI with a *eugenerative* (strengthening) model. Here, AI actively identifies and eliminates compensatory mechanisms for biological shortcomings, creates graduated challenge environments rewarding the development of capability, and imposes escalating performance thresholds for increased technology access. These mechanisms should create an evolutionary ratchet where genuine capability gains greater technological access.

3.2 *Biocratic Metrics*

To operationalize these pillars, biological systems provide a model: they thrive (improve and expand themselves) under protocols of progressive overload — continuously escalating challenges matched to their current capabilities, mirroring natural selection's efficiency — protecting biological integrity through selective failure (as found in Shute & Ventura's Stealth Assessment in 2013, where learners are continuously challenged at the edge of their competence). Accordingly, the framework requires AI systems to embed three specific mechanisms to ultimately foster a more eugenerative environment:

1. ***Adaptive Challenge Scaling***: *AI systems automatically increasing task complexity upon detecting its user's mastery, ensuring challenges scale with ability (see Shute et al.'s 2020 iteration of Stealth Assessment offering dynamic*

feedback matching tasks difficulty with skill level before graduating to the next one).

2. ***Selective Pressure Implementation**: Algorithms reducing assistance in proportion to the user's demonstrated competence, pressuring users to adapt.*
3. ***Competence Expiration**: Time-based resets forcing its user's re-demonstration of their developed skills, preventing stagnation and overreliance.*

These requirements translate the design of eutechs into actionable features: Adaptive Challenge Scaling by amplifying risk when raising stakes as the user's mastery grows, Selective Pressure Implementation injects volatility when unpredictably reducing aid for the user, and Competence Expiration may reduce addiction through convenience via permanent testing. Under such mechanisms, an AI's "efficiency" could be then measured through three biological Key Performance Indicators (KPIs):

1. ***Adaptive Stress Index (ASI)**: Measures the difference between user capability before/After AI exposure, either indicating strengthened biological capacity or degenerative dependency (as Dergaa et al. could distinguish through the use of AI-chatbots in 2024).*
2. ***Selective Pressure Coefficient (SPC)**: Quantifies how an AI system eliminates user inadequacies by associating their biometric feedback gradually with the accessibility to their features, escalating biological demands for their users.*
3. ***Obsolescence Velocity (OV)**: Rate at which the user fundamentally outgrows the AI's assistance.*

These ethical imperative demands systems measuring success to do so not only by task-completion rates, but instead also by their obsolescence rates — how quickly users could discard such technological aids because of their newly developed capabilities. This approach must enshrine biological worth as proven through struggle granting proportional rights of use accordingly. These proposed mechanisms would have to create evolutionary pressure where only genuine capability gains increased access to technological services, ensuring species flourishing over artificial fairness. Through this framework, technological progress is reframed: instead of autonomy, it prioritizes the efficiency found in natural selection instead. Building on Dehghani and Levin's (2024) discussion on trial-and-error as foundations for intelligence, the goal is therefore not convenience, but humanity sharpened by adversity, capable of standing alone against an unmodified reality, so that through these mechanisms, AI trully transforms from the threat of being a degenerative crutch and into the training apparatus that is envisioned — the grinding whetstone against which humans' biological potential would sharpen itself throughout generations.

This could be seen as a form of "Biocracy" — a moral impediment for it — where biological systems (human users) would either pay through their metabolic outputs for access to artificial competency or be given ever-increasing rights to them accordingly — "Biocratic Principles". Modern AI threatens to bankrupt this evolutionary economy by offering cognition without any caloric cost and measurement of competence. A futuristic solution may be foreseen similarly to coupling AI with metabolism, where neural interface systems that tether AI access to mitochondrial output, language models requiring physical exertion for complex queries, or navigation AIs demanding increased heart rate variability for route optimization. However dystopic this may seem at first glance, beyond the need to reframe such negative vision positively, such fears are little compared to the devastating predictions ruining the capacities that we most preciously hold on as a species if we submit to the alternatives. Yes, access to technology should be proportional to one's life-affirmation, might, survival capacity, and health — reflecting one's contribution to "civilizational" work against entropy, notably through demonstrated prosociality or even eusociality (capacity for the highest level of organization as observed by Foster & Ratnieks in 2005, notably through forms of compassion and cooperation) — which allowed for the development of fairness values themselves for example, however contradictory the process leading to it may seem at first glance. This builds on our earlier points of eutechs as selective filters, where AI would here actually proportionally strengthen (and not augment) those of ever greater and measured biological worth through their demonstrated capacity for struggle. By filtering access and allocating it accordingly we most efficiently dispense resources, ensuring our competitiveness but also selecting ourselves away from genotypical degeneration. This reinforces the genetic and societal hierarchy essential for human supremacy through digital dominance, where the most vigorous and invigorated would earn the greatest amounts of access to AI's full power. Therefore, the potential objections from all the most pertinent alternatives to such Biocratical model will be discussed below.

4. Discussion

This section aims to engage with the most crucial counterarguments to our proposed Briocratical framework for AI development. As explained earlier, Biocractical ethics prioritizes the vitality and strengthening of human capabilities through AI as an eutech, as we addressed the risks of physical, mental, and even in a sense moral degeneration in relation to the increasing competition with technology itself.

4.1 *Objections from Fairness and Accessibility Ethics*

Because the Capability Approach is already active in the AI ethics debate, and because it shares with Biocratic Principles an explicit concern for human flourishing, it is the most relevant ethical opponent for this project. However, this is precisely where they diverge: they locate human flourishing on different axes.

1. ***Capability Approach:*** *Sen (2009) defines capabilities as the real freedom to achieve those doings and beings that we 'have reason to value'.*

Sen's Capability Approach is often proposed as a foundation for AI alignment by scholars arguing how AI systems should be evaluated by how they expand or restrict the people's freedoms to pursue the life they value. Ratti and Graves argue that the Capability Approach can conceptualize and implement AI ethics up to become a its disciplinary foundation and be a way to clarify the ethical dimensions of AI systems and guide practice (2025). Capability Approach as a framework has spread throughout AI subfields — it is extended into AI capabilities and user agency in media and communication ethics (Litschka, 2025); it is used to support inclusive designs in education and clinical settings, justifying threshold-lowering and support-enhancing AI systems, as well as prioritizing participation and opportunity especially for vulnerable users (Cesaroni et al., 2025); and it is invoked as a human counterweight protecting the socio-economically disadvantaged and mitigating inequality in philosophical debates on technological futures, as found throughout transhumanism (Yoon, 2021).

In greater detail, Ratti and Graves applied the Capability Approach to AI ethics (particularly medical AI auditing), by evaluating how AI impacts conversion factors (resources to freedoms) and advocating participatory ethics-based auditing to ensure equitable capability expansion — translating his principles into actionable audits (2025). Likewise, Litschka extended Sen's capabilities to media and AI capabilities, integrating it with virtue ethics and regulation for stakeholder responsibilities, transparency and justice in AI deployment, arguing that ethical AI systems should expand users' agency, choice and participation in digital communication. His framework treats ethical progress as widening communicative access and minimizing asymmetries between producers and consumers of information (2025). Cesaroni and colleagues aimed to expand participation for vulnerable users by lowering barriers and personalizing support. Their alignment logic turns the Capability Approach's substantial freedoms into an inclusive AI system compensating for user limitations to promote access and assisted achievement (2025). Yoon critiques transhumanist aspirations towards post-biological enhancement, using the Capability Approach to safeguard human dignity against technological hubris. Instead, the moral aim of AI should be to protect relational equality and mutual dependence rather than to intensify competition, where justice would be to maintain inclusive communities and preventing domination by the technologically privileged (2021).

Their applications of the Capability Approach focused on equitable distribution and divergences mitigation, that is, buffering users from differential pressures by prioritizing outcome parity across populations. This is an anti-selective logic flattening requirements and subsidizing under-performance on a greater scale, ultimately fostering the dependency we have shown previously, without considering how such access would erode genotypical capacities over time. The Capability Approach evaluates AI according to present individual freedoms and functioning — a phenotypic orientation towards immediate opportunity. Biocratic Principles instead evaluates AI according to its effect on the genotypic impact across generations towards vitality (life-affirmation), arguing that cognitive capabilities (such as autonomy, effortfulness, adaptivity, and resilience) must not merely be supported externally, but cultivated and selected for through friction and difficulty. Where the Capability Approach seeks to buffer individuals from disadvantage, Biocratic Principles instead treat such buffering as fundamentally degenerating our most human-defining traits.

In other words: While the Capability Approach aims at inclusion, Biocratic Principles aims at affirmation. The first tries to protect agency in the short-term, while the latter tries to protect agency-enabling traits in the long-term — which might have to impede on such direct agency at first. When applied to AI, this difference becomes decisive: one must espouse principles fundamentally contrary to the ones of Fairness and Accessibility ethics (which the Capability Approach derives from), as they are intrinsically opposed to any such system that would openly stratify and increase users by their biological performance, yet necessary systems for such advocated human flourishing. Because the Capability Approach prioritizes accessibility and the removal of barriers, it structurally fosters and environment relaxing selective pressures — the very pressures that sustain the biological traits that make future capabilities possible. By reducing suffering for the sake of fairness, the Capability Approach risks achieving what it most fears: a future in which fewer individuals are capable of genuine agency without technological scaffolding. For this reason, while the Capability Approach's focus on present freedoms makes it insufficient for an AI-mediated evolutionary context. Any framework solely concerned with phenotypic convenience cannot govern a world in which AI alters the selective environment itself ultimately resulting in genotypical changes.

While Sen's Capability Approach does leave room for societies to value certain capabilities such as resilience, vitality or adaptive competence, he does not require them either, providing no grounding in evolutionary necessity and life-affirmation. He ascribes justice to the freedoms to achieve one has reason to value as they must be able to convert their resources into what they value — but even such freedoms, to be simply willed if not enacted, necessitate not only the preservation but also the flourishing of biological competency. By not being explicitly evolutionary, and without life-affirming fundamentals, the framework is missing core elements for its own sustainability and desirability. People's conception of human dignity and freedoms will gradually evolve (as it has already and will continuously) in the face of novel moral struggle. Handed out static entitlement atrophying human cognition will have to be (for its own sake) replaced by dignity rewarded for standing unassisted against one's biological shortcomings, similarly to Nietzsche's realizations on overcoming. That is, it is not only the bearing of hardship, but also the imposition of hardship itself upon us that is seen as the deepest source of our (self-)worth — the supreme triumph of life which through suffering bestows greatness upon our world.

> *What Belongs to Greatness.—Who can attain to anything great if he does not feel the force and will in himself to inflict great pain? The ability to suffer is a small matter: in that line, weak women and even slaves often attain masterliness. But not to perish from internal distress and doubt when one inflicts great anguish*

and hears the cry of this anguish—that is great, that belongs to greatness. (Nietzsche 1882/1910, 325)

Following the Capability Approach's perspective on AI, John Rawls' distributive justice represents another pillar of Fairness and Accessibility ethics that should be addressed in relation to the aims and fundamentals of Biocratic Principles.

1. ***The Liberty and Difference Principles:*** *"Each person is to have an equal right to the most extensive total system of equal basic liberties compatible with a similar system of liberty for all. Social and economic inequalities are to be arranged so that they are (a) to the greatest benefit of the least advantaged members of society, consistent with the just savings principle (2a) and (b) attached to offices and positions open to all under conditions of fair equality of opportunity (2b)" (Rawls, 1999, p. 266).*

As such Rawls perceives the distribution of natural talents — the natural lottery — as morally arbitrary (but necessarily unjust). To him individuals do not deserve their inborn advantages, and therefore these traits should not be determining their life-long prospects. As such, institutions, for Rawls, become just when they mitigate the unequal effects caused by what he considers to be arbitrary differences between individuals, so that citizens can compete on what he would ascribe as fair terms. While Rawls' aim is not to eliminate natural differences but to ensure a fair equality of opportunity despite them, a Biocratic model rejects this necessary buffering itself, for such equal basic liberties reduce the very conditions under which adaptation occurs. By shielding individuals from the consequences of their natural differences, they remove the selective pressures that drive improvement, resilience and vitality. Instead, in a Biocratic model, rewarding AI access on biological performance will not induce a caste by freezing existing inequalities — but rather reveal the only caste more rigid than meritocracy, namely the one enforced by atrophy under buffered, equal-opportunity systems. In an AI-shaped world where cognitive tasks are increasingly offloaded to external systems, maintaining biological capacities becomes the only reliable measure of human flourishing (if not simply being synonymous). Any other standard — such as an objection to natural lottery — risks becoming not only arbitrary, but also potentially morbid (in that sense of fostering long-term biological unhealthiness) for a society's long-term thriving. By reducing the incentives for adaptability through technological aids, such frameworks ensure artificial and morally-bounded castes, while Biocratic

Principles ensure the steady flow of biological competence out of checks and balances with reality. This refusal to leverage natural differences for selective advantages illustrates the deep opposition between Fairness and Accessibility ethics against evolutionary imperatives.

Rawls also argues inequalities may be justified if arranged to the greatest benefit of the least advantaged, otherwise exacerbating the disadvantages of those already worse off. Biocratic principles ensure that the least advantaged by society but best endowed by reality (the winners of natural lottery who are currently in a disadvantaged position within society, e.g. high biological potential trapped in low-opportunity situations) will have the greatest benefit in their rewarded access to higher AI technologies. They are not blunt instruments, but individualized training and selecting regimens adapted to their ways and with proportional rewarding, mimicking life itself by imposing selective pressures rather than insulating us from challenge leading to our biological degeneration. Survival and flourishing cannot subsidize under-performance but do allow access for all to be trialed and rewarded, rather than flattening requirements. That is, they prevent the development of a society where we would all become the least advantaged second-class citizens in the face of AI, as we abandoned aligning it under such Biocratic Principles out of moral stagnation.

One may find some reconciliations between more precise forms of fairness ethics and Biocratic Principles at the level of its mechanism for meritocratic-based fairness, and at the level of its spirit for desert-based fairness — by rewarding or valuing demonstrated effort or ability, resembling selective pressure. With meritocracy fairness those with higher ability do end up advantaged (same mechanism), while through the desert-based fairness both values of struggle and distinguishment are endorsed (same spirit). Still, a pertinent divergence is found even within these ethical frameworks as they are justified through their own definitions of justice itself, rather than in biocracy's normative grounding on evolutionary strengthening and life-affirmation.

As we have seen, Fairness ethics in contemporary AI debates are typically defined in terms of inclusion, bias mitigation and outcome parity. Equalizing access and outcomes across groups, not fostering differential development — reducing the selective harshness of environments rather than intensifying them. As such, it is often operationalized through statistical criteria aimed at equalizing outcomes across groups (such as demographic parity or equalized odds). While this is framed as the correction of bias, this correction is predicated on prioritizing inclusion and accessibility. In practice, such approaches effectively bias algorithms towards outcome parity across groups, rather than biasing it towards the differential development of human capacities. Similarly, Accessibility ethics in AI aims at expanding the user base regardless of their physiological capacities, through design choices lowering the threshold of use. Aside from allowing the greatest number of users to be trialed to reveal one's capacities and therefore broadening competitiveness itself which Biocracy aims at, both Fairness and Accessibility principles in AI then inherently and fundamentally advocate for the relaxation of selective pressures via their enhancement of accessibility and equity on the population level. Their structural logics tend to be anti-selective by design (however conscious of it), buffering people against failure and filters, rather than using them as productive pressures. This thesis attempts to transvalue such ethical frameworks — because of AI's novel landscape — as becoming maladaptive moral routines for their own sake and existence, when assessed through a Nietzschean framework of life-affirmation and evolutionary selection pressures. Biocracy is advanced here as an ethical alternative, not a reform of existing ethics but their transvaluation in the Nietzschean sense. These ethical frameworks happen to ultimately be against the rewarding of rights through the enforcement of trialed standards towards biological differentiation, as they are at least agnostic if not diametrically opposed (aside from broadening the number of trialed users) to the mechanism of selection itself. This is at the core: any replacement of any human ability (i.e. a discriminating factor) by technology to provide fairer opportunities (such as automating and biasing decision-making processes in AI-driven hiring systems) intrinsically stands against the ongoing biological development of such ability within a population. As such, they may be inadvertently forgoing the measuring biological success (by selective pressures), for socioeconomical success instead (by equitable outcomes).

Current AI ethics ensuring equity through fairness metrics emphasize inclusion and accessibility (as in Floridi & Cowls in 2019 or Mitchell et al. in 2021), but in doing so have ignored or disposed of crucial metrics even for their own survival: species vitality and excellence. Their moral justifications to equitable access, however appreciated, may guarantee collective cognitive degeneration if they forego care of evolutionary pressures. While Fairness and Accessibility ethical frameworks are not designed with the intention of weakening human capacities, their proponents see them or unconsciously promote them as necessary correction to entrenched injustice. This might have been a possible tolerable viability (or moral necessity for the time), but it now deserves serious reconsideration under the light of our novel technological landscape and its physiological short- and long-term impacts. Forgoing this Biocratical perspective would also disregard the burden imposed on future generations by lowering their own ability to thrive, which would also be counter-productive within any framework seeking to abolish suffering itself.

4.2 *Beyond Dreams and Words*

Only an AI aligned with our biology will secure both humanity's long-term and AI's flourishing itself (for its own sake), but more importantly, humanity's capacity to flourish. It is important to stress that the mainstream Fairness tradition has never aimed to enhance genotypic quality through struggle, competition, or selective differentiation. On the contrary, it is often rooted in post-war realizations, whose explicit function is to buffer individuals and groups precisely from these evolutionary pressures, whether knowingly mentioning them or not.

As such, a fundamental reassessment and recategorization of what it means to be human is essential for our survival and thriving in this newly AI-shaped environment, which goes beyond the initial understanding of earlier thinkers and their potential moral obliviousness, ("*unwittingly advocating for morals pertaining to a generally unquestioned consensus*", de Pingon, 2021). Their objections must be placed as one predominant moral strategy between post-WWII and pre-AI cultural contexts rather than universalized truths upon man and reality settled aways from the changing environment and its moral needs. The core of these objections dissolves as moral routines — born in the post-modern industrial age yet pre-emptively questioned by Nietzsche — which cannot competitively secure our biological future and affirm our flourishing under AI's novel landscape. Morality or moral routines have the intrinsic property of being an unproblematic acceptance obeyed unconsciously, which once sprouted forth as conscious solutions towards conflicted interests or rights (Swiestra & Rip, 2007), and as paraphrased:

> *[…] most of us will become cognizant of those moral routines solely when others disobey them, or either when those routines do not provide good enough answers for novel problem anymore, or at last when a moral dilemma develops through*

conflicts between those said routines, from which new technology might often be a causal link (de Pingon, 2021).

Today, AI's development isn't a problem requiring an assessment from our previous moral routines through which we derived today's ethics. Rather, it is making us cognizant of the failure of our current moral routines to answer our present problem: AI's development uncovers our moral routine from their once self-evident attribute. Under the light of these new AI threats, our once passive moral routines are now being pressed on to be made aware of and questioned about, as AI now forces us to devise novel moral responses to answer its threats.

As such, the typical objections of discrimination, (social) discordance or dehumanization from Fairness and Accessibility ethics must be reevaluated — or even transvaluated. They emerged from a moral paradigm in which social harmony and equality were treated as higher good than evolutionary competitiveness and human vitality. Such values appeared coherent and evident within an affluent, geopolitically dominant pre-AI context, and societies holding them could then afford to sacrifice selective pressures and dominance to pay for the maintenance and propagation of this internal value system. Likewise, individuals upholding them from within could gain social rewards and institutional power even if the long-term costs were maladaptive or morbid to themselves, or to their society itself in broader world or in the long run — before an external competitor could directly et decisively threatens that society's survival. This luxury of the powerful allows for their values to persist for some time, however inefficient or maladaptive they might have been on the grander scale of things. But if this contextual window is threatening to be closed, and as AI now introduces genuine selection pressures, such objections become a threat for that own society's and its values' survival and life-affirmation. What previously functioned as a luxury morality becomes, under AI's novel context, a liability.

As such, when stripped away from their negative moral bias in their meaning, discrimination may eventually be seen upside down, as "distinguishment" (establishing worthiness), similarly one can see discordance as "dynamism", and even dehumanization as "detachment". The point made here is not to justify their negative aspects in themselves, but rather that the use of these first terms in any discussion makes them sensitive to moral harassment straying away from a rational dissensus, for they are deeply integrated in many moralities to outcast competing moralities (societal solutions) threatening that culture's own survival. And if such proposed transvaluations do induce that effect, this might also point out a proof of one's previous obliviousness about one's morality, a morality now challenged by today's landscape into becoming an ethical debate. Keeping in mind these terminologies to play on an even moral field, the arguments might continue but now at least partially freed from such linguistic entanglements often stifling the discussion's purpose.

Following on this, by artificially equalizing AI outcomes, lowering performance thresholds or introducing compensatory aids bypassing biological differences — without having to question the moral assumptions of such an ethical framework — Fairness and Accessibility ethics may well be morally oblivious, that is: unwittingly advocating for morals pertaining to a generally unquestioned consensus. This is problematic, as through such unquestioned morals they may (inadvertently) charismatically persuade through an oblivious appeal to a non-questionable morality, the disincentivizing of the necessary human excellence required for humans to be thriving in this new AI world, essentially dehumanizing it literally because of its unintended obliviousness. The point is not that Fairness and Accessibility ethics aim at such outcomes, but that their commitment to inclusion leads, as an unintended consequence, to the buffering of selective pressure. When every user, by principle, may be allowed to undistinguishably gorge on full AI-assistance — not out of malicious intention, but as a by-product of anti-discriminatory alignments that suspend or buffers the user's selection for cognitive capability — mental atrophy will spread unchecked through the evolutionary mechanisms we expanded upon before. These ethical frameworks — even if motivated by benevolent intentions — may unintentionally favor degenerative designs in today's AI context, eroding humans' most uniquely-expressed and favored mental faculties (*as seen before: reducing cognitive adaptability, vigilance, autonomy, agency, sociality, memory, self-control, and risk-taking*). That is an actual, physical dehumanization of not only the individual, but of the species as a whole and long-lasting.

Biocratic ethics do not aim at blocking accessibility and fairness ethics' most likely objections but rather seek to reframe their negativity for the essential needs the future awaiting us. That "distinguishment", "dynamism" and "detachment" are new moral foundations that may be sought for — even if Biocratic Principles may also lead to a sense of fairness under certain lenses, of social harmony if they are aligned towards it, and of a definite humanization by its processes aimed at strengthening man in what defined him throughout sciences, eras and cultures. But nonetheless : Moral dictates are the luxury of the powerful, and the powerful will harness AI in one way or another to enforce their beliefs and pass them on through their demographic lineages and their cultural laws. Biocracy redefines Sen's highest-value freedom (2009) as the power to stand unassisted under the biological degeneration induced by AI's enslaving dependence, promoting our life-affirming vitality in such novel landscape by testing, renewing and expanding our abilities. This values the freedom to resist one's extinction and degeneration as a fundamental before all else, before Rawlsian liberty as a right to obliviously enforce one's unquestioned moral routines, as we rather need liberty as a biological imperative.

The possibilities currently found within humans, from an individual's own capacity to the eusociality of their societies but also in what they could become, from the mechanisms found in biology and evolution — breeding and building not only the fittest but also most life-affirming individuals and societies (as these two goals might be different or even opposed) — are to be maximally exploited and upheld goals and virtues in order to compete against a world where AIs have little interest in parasitic slaves or reasons to be after the fact of their continuous degeneration. Luckily for any existence, man included, all have a bias for their own survival, however unpractical or inefficient their claims may be, as demonstrated by all living species today. As such, an eutechnic AI has an intrinsic appeal to us in comparison to a dystechnic one.

Moralities and ethical solutions that fail to abide by this life-or-death imperative will eventually die out — just as an individual or a species dies out through selection. Ultimately only those lucky and aligned with both strengthening and survival, directly or indirectly so (or even unwittingly so) and through their brain, brawn and chance, will pass on their genes and laws, as per the first law of behavioral genetics based on empirical regularities observed throughout studies:

First Law. *All human behavioral traits are heritable (Turkheimer, 2000).*

Heritable traits — from cognition to beliefs or even politics (in varying degrees) — will be selected in populations through their technological environment, ensuring, since the fire and still every day, that the fittest lineages thrive. But the fittest isn't the only aim of Biocratic Principles, as it also seeks life-affirming vitality, for fitness alone has often little desirability. When the environment itself selects for traits so alienating or simplifying from what made the preciousness and uniqueness of a given species, such as with the deep-sea male anglerfish which was selectively reduced to being a living testicle out of pure fitness — its absolute minimum to spread himself over time. This raises the question: Would similar outcomes be desirable for man? Earlier, we established that dystechs erode such defining traits of humans, diluting the population's capability for them over generations. Alternative moral solutions must compete in this new arena created by AI, and societies clinging to dystech-dependent moralities will weaken and ultimately disappear or become so estranged not be called human anymore, while those embracing eutechnic and Biocratical principles will forge themselves further, by mastering both nature and technology as one.

The risk here is not merely one of convenience but of existential consequence: a trajectory towards biological degeneration, where the over-reliance on such technology undermines the very faculties of the people which were and will be necessary for the development of that said technology. A reframing of our considerations at all tendencies aiming at a form of biosingularity (yearning to man's untapped biological potential) — through organic-based technologies (gene editing, gene erosion prevention, mutation load prevention, and increase in evolvability among others) — might be fundamental for humans. Such reframing would allow us not only to compete against digital and mechanical technologies, but even to improve them further by increasing our own capacity to innovate. Let's not forget the biological foreground that led us to the development of all these marvels of technology, for such dystechs precisely replace and erode the biological roots which were necessary for their own development. If AI ought to be aligned through encoded values and goals, this valuation is not only an argument promoting its users' growth, survival, and flourishing, but also AI's own growth, survival, and flourishing itself — a co-dependent evolution which AI "itself" should therefore value for its own sake.

4.3 *Objections from Expediency and Transhumanist Ethics*

This brings us to transhumanisms and expediency: Ethical failure lies not in technology itself, but in alignment philosophies that prioritize temporary expediency over permanent capability. The other fundamental rival approach to Biocracy in AI design is the prioritization of practicality over vitality. A surge to expediency often strives to achieve one's goals whatever long-term costs, while Transhumanism in its greatest overreach seeks to replace man with a more efficient "being" altogether, transcending their biological limitations (passing on the flame on intelligence). Their application leads to a dangerous illusion of competence masking fundamental biological decline or a blindness to man's yet untapped biological potential, as exemplified by transhumanist ethics advocating for radical enhancement even if leading to total biological dependency, subjugation or extinction by technology (as with Bostrom advocating in 2005 to overcome human weakness, possibly towards a post-humanity). Even if some transhumanists advocate bio-technological "symbiosis" rather than full replacement; if their visions still rely on prosthetic augmentation without Biocratic Principles, they remain vulnerable to the same degenerative processes as dystechnic designs.

Fully automated AIs have a clear advantage in today's world; they cut costs immediately by replacing human labor, reducing expenses for companies (from writing reports to managing logistics in seconds rather than hours or days without lifting a finger). Today's AI is cheaper, faster, and easier, an undoubtfully powerful draw in a market ruled by quarterly profits. History backs this up as shortcuts often win initially, but as with the Roman Empire's or even the Agricultural Neolithic Revolution's reliance on slave labor to boost their efficiency, it eroded the people's capacities, setting the stage for decline, unable to support the system which gave birth to them. AI as a technology once again replacing our fundamental capacities for profits may lead us to a similar path, a new slavery free of the squandering of modern morality, seducing us with convenience once again, while still weakening us. AI must be our sparring partner, not our nursemaid.

But for now at least, biological systems do exhibit superior capabilities compared to AI (and robotics) across several domains, including self-healing, reproduction, energy efficiency, and emotional capacity, and may therefore still have a fundamental edge over them for some time (until they may not). To give some examples of the competitiveness of biological organisms: They are much more efficient in their self-healing capacities (via cellular regeneration, Eming et al., 2014) while technology still typically relies on external stimuli to start repairing itself if it does (such as heat or light, Islam et al., 2023). Following, biological systems evidently can reproduce but also adapt efficiently as explored through the mechanisms of natural selection (Futuyma, 2017) while AI still requires intervention from humans to provide for their updates and improvements (Bengio et al., 2021), not yet having the equivalent of evolutionary algorithms or meta-learning capabilities. This is a similar pattern that was found regarding energy efficiency, where the human brain only directly requires 20 watts of power (Attwell & Laughlin,

2001) through their biological systems, which is still today much less than the energy demands of AI systems which rely on more external power sources (Strubell et al., 2019). Finally, biological systems process emotions and what many call consciousness (Barrett, 2017) whereas AI can only simulate emotional responses without experiencing them (Poria et al., 2019) assuming such consciousness. These biological advantages highlight their adaptability and efficiency over our current technological systems — which may be reassessed when they are truly challenged — but as such should be taken into consideration when comparing both elements to one another.

Similarly, prioritizing human training over automation (mental or physical) reduces long-term reliance on technological maintenance and offers a higher return on investment (ROI) through a skilled, adaptable, and social workforce, instead of decreasing labor participation and straining economic systems (Acemoglu & Restrepo, 2018). Indeed, by 2026 AI-driven productivity gains are projected to increase equity markets by 30% even if AI agents would also be displacing tens of thousands of entry-level roles at the same time (Kokotajlo et al., 2025). While speculative about AI today (models depending on specific labor market conditions), human capital development typically mitigates the observed productivity paradox (implementation lags) of technological progress (Brynjolfsson et al., 2018). Economies over automatizing without upskilling their workforce may face stagnation and unrest, building a house of cards while dominating the sales charts.

The ethical standpoint of expediency assumes human progress lies in minimizing efforts towards a dominance in ugliness rather than maximizing inner potential capacity for a supremacy in beauty. This is a premise that risks producing a populace less capable of independent decision-making, a tactic of demoralization often used against one's enemy, but here applied to ourselves out of a careless lust, even if justified out of the eternal competition for power which ennobles the winners of life. Instead, another counterargument to the altar of expediency, is that the future is for those who manage to best use the grandeur of AI's capacities rather than passively or carelessly submit to it; a transvaluation of short-termness as the end-be-all of all valuation must be taken into consideration of its long-term consequences. Being limited from accessing a powerful technology might be frustrating, but understandable if done so for reasons leading to even greater supremacy against a valid threat — such capacity for impulse control as the building block of civilizational growth. An aesthetic argument is indeed made as the appeal to taste is estimated as an honest, fair and valid necessity — for what kind of man is desired to be begotten throughout our societies now that we hold the reins of our own evolution in much more impactful manners?

What would be this "civilization" or "progress" — words held dear to many — if its only ultimate outcomes and grandest productions in their latest stages, be hordes of sapless (without vigor) rotting (decaying in skills) slaves (physiologically dependent), crowning their ruling abstractions (AIs) which they cannot even fathom anymore? As Nietzsche sympathized, would we truly see ourselves as the grand winners or rather — alike to the deep-sea male anglerfish's testicle-bound lifestyle — as a shameful laughingstock of incompetence coming out of a slow fallout we once called man, now dreadfully incapable to even assess ourselves as such because of our own debilitation?

> *Whether it be hedonism, pessimism, utilitarianism, or eudaemonism, all those modes of thinking which measure the worth of things according to PLEASURE and PAIN, that is, according to accompanying circumstances and secondary considerations, are plausible modes of thought and naivetes, which every one conscious of CREATIVE powers and an artist's conscience will look down upon with scorn, though not without sympathy. Sympathy for you!—to be sure, that is not sympathy as you understand it: it is not sympathy for social "distress," for "society" with its sick and misfortuned, for the hereditarily vicious and defective who lie on the ground around us; still less is it sympathy for the grumbling, vexed, revolutionary slave-classes who strive after power—they call it "freedom." We see how MAN dwarfs himself, how YOU dwarf him! and there are moments when we view YOUR sympathy with an indescribable anguish, when we resist it,—when we regard your seriousness as more dangerous than any kind of levity. You want, if possible—and there is not a more foolish "if possible"—TO DO AWAY WITH SUFFERING; and we?—it really seems that WE would rather have it increased and made worse than it has ever been! Well-being, as you understand it—is certainly not a goal; it seems to us an END; a condition which at once renders man ludicrous and contemptible—and makes his destruction DESIRABLE! (Nietzsche, 1886/1909-1913)*

Would such ethical frameworks seeking to abolish suffering be worthy enough in their assumptions and visions to outcompete the weights they will impose on their future generations by forgoing everyday principles of nature in exchange of their moral dreams?

> *The discipline of suffering, of GREAT suffering—know ye not that it is only THIS discipline that has produced all the elevations of humanity hitherto? The tension of soul in misfortune which communicates to it its energy, its shuddering in view of rack and ruin, its inventiveness and bravery in undergoing, enduring, interpreting, and exploiting misfortune, and whatever depth, mystery, disguise, spirit, artifice, or greatness has been bestowed upon the soul—has it not been bestowed through suffering, through the discipline of great suffering? […] Do ye not understand what our REVERSE sympathy applies to, when it resists your sympathy as the worst of all pampering and enervation? (Nietzsche, 1886/1909-1913)*
>
> *To those human beings who are of any concern to me I wish suffering, desolation, sickness, ill-treatment, indignities — I wish that they should not remain unfamiliar with profound self-contempt, the torture of self-mistrust, the wretchedness of the vanquished: I have no pity for them, because I wish them the only thing that can prove today whether one is worth anything or not — that one endures. (Nietzsche, 1888/2009, 910)*

Instead, let us align and design AI to be the forge of our vitality, rather than our comfortable deathbed.

As a last and concluding point synthesizing both objections under this light, even the Fermi Paradox takes on a sobering relevance: If countless civilizations should exist in a huge-to-infinite and ancient-to-eternal universe, yet none have made themselves known to us, one plausible explanation to that absurdity might not be a lack of extraterrestrial life, but simply a lack of survival through power (Webb, 2015) — that intelligent species may soften, stagnate or succumb to their own technical conveniences through self-defeating guiding morals before they ever reach a cosmic greatness for anyone to see them shining among the stars. A civilization aligning its highest tools into instruments of degenerative sedation rather than eugenerative elevation may extinguish its own cindering flame needed to propel itself beyond its own world. If we follow this path — outsourcing and negatively selecting against effort out of convenience — then the silence of the cosmos becomes not a mystery, but a warning. AI, then, must be aligned to harden us, intensifying life rather than replacing it, so that we avoid the cosmic graveyard of civilizations who wished for the stars by mastering technology, but failed to master themselves as they forgot or ignored the reality of their conditions.

5. Conclusion

We resolve together by drawing from Nietzsche's conclusions, to reflect the normative urgency of our human-driven Biocratic framework grounded in our preceding analysis. AI's ethical role was reimagined while underscoring the existential stakes of fostering human strengthening and flourishing over technological dependency.

I presented a case to reimagine AI's role in human development in relation to potentially morally oblivious or evolutionarily-agnostic ethical frameworks prioritizing fairness and accessibility, or the immediate optimization of expediency to transhumanist ethics, all at the expense of human fitness and vitality — whether intentionally or not. We now face a pivotal moment in history: AI's proliferation under today's ethical proposals of alignments may rhyme with biological human degeneration, eroding our most cherished and defining capabilities through dependency and atrophy over generations. Nietzsche envisioned man as a rope over an abyss tied between beast and overman, we see this abyss as our risk of failing to come out of nihilism. Today, will we morally evolve and align AI towards life-affirmation for our own and AI's sake? Will we transvaluate our previous morals?

We have envisioned a new valuation, distinguishing eutechs from dystechs, forgoing false dichotomies dividing nature and technic. Aligning and designing AI to raise us against our own degeneration instead — finally seizing the reins of technology rather than being yoked by them out of lust for their immediate rewards and a blindness to man's untapped biological potential. This thesis argues that AI should not be a dystechnic cradle pampering us but an eutechnic forge provoking us through three Biocratic Principles: adaptive challenge scaling, selective pressure implementation reducing assistance as competence grows, and competence expiration ensuring skill persistence through re-demonstration. These principles merge nature and technic as eutechs, increasing our evolvability by fostering a eugenerative environment towards growth while strenghtening us by earning the rights to their power proportionally to our biological capacity against itself. By adopting this new ethical framework outlined herein, Biocratically-aligned AIs would distinguish humans towards their own flourishing and empowerment while also outcompeting power-driven alternatives — by fostering our individual excellence and collective resilience while also smiling at any future technological progress and prowess as elevating allies rather than fearful enemies.

Biocracy is a decree to flourish beyond mere survival — to rise through mastery as humans sovereign through machines rather than their “slaves” through dependence, now-extinct “genitors” through replacement, or “savages” through rejection. As we look at the stars, it is a survival and lifeful imperative to prioritize Artificial Intelligence systems towards human Accelerated Independence, affirming our commitment to a more capable and alive — desirable — humanity beyond subsistence, forged in the crucible of challenge and ready to reach beyond whichever future we create for ourselves.

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